

EDCI 57300 Assignment Descriptions

Assignment 1: Pre-proposal selection, identification, and sign-off

Purpose:

The pre-proposal assignment is used to ensure that within the first few days of the term the student has identified a potential practicum project that will qualify for practicum credit, obtained preliminary approvals for the project from the primary stakeholders, and identified a potential supervisor within that organization for the project. With acceptance by the course instructor, the signed pre-proposal gives approval for the student to submit a formal proposal and timeline to the stakeholder organization, supervisor, and the course instructor.

The pre-proposal is designed to be a quick review so that all interested parties know what the focus of the project will be and if it will be something that is wanted and that can be accomplished in the timeframe of the course.

In some cases, multiple pre-proposals may be submitted by a student at the same time so the course instructor can help counsel the student in what would be the optimal project to work on.

Assignment requirements:

Brief one page summary of the potential project (can use bullet points) that describes:

- What the project would consist of (basic description);
- Where it will occur (organization, site);
- Potential audience for the completed work;
- A list of the potential deliverables;
- Who would serve as the project supervisor; and
- Any additional clarifications as to why this project should qualify for a practicum

Due date:

Within the first few days of the semester (Thursday of Week 1 at the latest). If at all possible, complete this assignment and turn it in before or on the first day of class.

Grading rubric (10 pts.):

Grading for this assignment will consist of a grade of:

- ACCEPT (10 pts. Go on to the full proposal and begin the project),
- REDO and RESUBMIT (more information is needed about this project), or
- REJECT (find another project and resubmit).

The decision will be based on the course instructor answering the following questions after reading the pre-proposal:

1. Is the proposal written in a concise format that clearly presents the potential project?

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2. Is all critical information included? If so, what is still needed?
3. Will this project require the needed amount of effort (thought, time, skill) by the student to be considered adequate but not overwhelming within the EDCI 573 course time frame?
4. Will this proposed project provide the student with the educational experience needed to apply and use proper instructional design, development, and/or evaluation skills?
5. Does the project appear to have proper support from the organization where the project will occur?
6. Is the supervisor appropriate for this project?

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Assignment 2: Project proposal

Purpose:

Once the pre-proposal has been accepted by your course instructor, a full project proposal will be completed. This proposal should contain a full description of what the project entails, your role in the completion of the work (what you will be doing), the goals of the project, the deliverables that will be produced and a detailed timeline (week by week) of what will be accomplished by you during this term as you complete the practicum. If this project is a part of a larger project, an explanation of how your target project fits within the global project should be included. Likewise, if your role is working within a group that will be completing a large, comprehensive project for the organization, your role within the group needs to be fully explained.

No project ever goes as planned. However, from the beginning you should note and include within this proposal any possible constraints or potential problems that need to be considered.

IMPORTANT NOTE: As a word of warning, it is highly recommended that you not attempt to learn a totally new technology (at least new to you) while conducting your practicum. You will have your hands full with completing the project, adding the time and effort needed to also learn and integrate a new technology often creates more problems than it solves.

Assignment requirements:

The proposal will consist of three main parts. First, you will write a 1-2 page (single spaced) narrative that will include the following:

- Project description;
- Title and description of the organization* where the project will be completed (e.g., school description, company, training organization);
- Goals of the completed project; including a list of the final deliverables (artifacts) that will be produced;
- Identification and description of the ID model or evaluation model that will be used;
- How the finished project will be used (or how it fits) within the organization;
- A description of how, when, and by whom the project will be evaluated;
- Your specific role in the project, specifically highlight the ID/HPT skills you plan to utilize within the project;
- Who the supervisor of the project will be (name, contact information, position within the organization)

Second, you will fill out and attach the Practicum Project Plan (a spreadsheet document found in the Course Documents section of this Brightspace course). This will allow you to identify all key artifacts/deliverables/components/activities as well as you estimated time, who will have the primary responsibility, and a timeline for completion.

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Finally, you will submit an email, letter, or signed copy of the proposal by the project supervisor. This is required before the proposal will be reviewed and accepted by the course instructor. This is to ensure that full buy-in and support from the supervisor and his/her organization has been obtained. To help you when you discuss the project with your supervisor, consider accessing and using the Stakeholder/Supervisor Interview Form found in the Course Documents section of this Brightspace course.

* There are occasions where some information needs to be withheld because of proprietary rights. If your project/work fall within such a situation, create a pseudo name for the organization and explain that within the proposal.

Project communication:

Once the formal proposal has been accepted, the course supervisor will contact your project supervisor (generally completed by email). This communication will outline the role of the supervisor and open the lines of communication between the course instructor and the supervisor. Please inform your supervisor that this communication will occur. Likewise, provide the contact email of your course instructor to your supervisor so that if he/she has any questions, they can quickly be addressed.

Due date:

The formal project proposal is due at the end of Week 2 of the term. NOTE: A completed proposal includes having your supervisor read it, agree to what is written, and signing off on the document. Some updates may be needed based on the supervisor's review. Make sure you plan for the supervisor's review to be sure all is completed by the due date of this assignment.

Grading rubric (20 pts.):

- ___ The proposal is concise, complete, and well written (with few grammar or spelling problems).
- ___ The project description and goals are clearly explained within the document.
- ___ The ID model or evaluation model used was clearly identified and described;
- ___ The role of the student for the completion of the project is fully explained.
- ___ The deliverables of the project (the project artifacts) are identified and described (note: you may need to change these later in the project, but at this point their initial identification is required).
- ___ The Practicum Project Plan (spreadsheet) has been fully completed including the identification of all key artifacts/deliverables/components/activities, estimated work hours and duration, and full timeline..
- ___ Sign off by the supervisor of the project has been obtained and all relevant contact information for the supervisor is included.

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Assignment 3: Project Artifact

Purpose:

Project artifacts, (such as reports, surveys, design documents, prototypes) will be generated throughout the process of completing the project. Often these are associated with specific milestones of the project. The artifact you are to submit for this assignment will vary based on the type of project that is being completed. The purpose of this assignment is to highlight one of the artifacts you complete (by writing, designing, developing, etc.) during the course of the full project completion.

Assignment requirements:

NOTE: The selected artifact for this assignment will be very specific to your specific project. Your course instructor will not be able to tell you what the artifact will be for your project, you will need to inform him/her what artifact to expect.

During the course of the practicum, a minimum of 1 key project artifact should be submitted for review by the course instructor. If you feel the need to submit additional artifacts to gain clarity and feedback, please feel free to do so.

Each submitted artifact should include the following:

- A copy of the artifact (e.g., a copy of the report, project prototype, design document)
- A brief 1-2 page report is included for each artifact that addresses the following sections (make sure these sections have headers within the report):
 - Executive summary / abstract of the practicum;
 - Narrative summary of the artifact (i.e., what it is and how it relates to the full project);
 - The lessons learned in regards to how it applies to the project and how it impacts your ID skills;
 - How the artifact relates to the ID process (e.g., where in the D&C model does it fit?)
- The report is written in clear, academic language

Due date:

By the conclusion of Week 4 of the term, a minimum of one artifact should be submitted. This will constitute Assignment 3.

Grading rubric for Assignment 3 (20 pts.):

___ A minimum of 1 key artifact was submitted for each assignment.

___ The written report accompanying each artifact was clearly written with no grammatical or spelling problems.

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___ Each written report included an executive summary, narrative summary, lessons learned, and how it relates to the overall project.

Assignment 4: Final Complete Project

Purpose:

The final effort of the practicum will be submitting the fully completed project (e.g., a new module for an online course, a complete needs assessment final report, a completed training packet/DVD, etc.). This project is submitted to demonstrate to what degree the project goals have been achieved.

NOTE: In some cases, proprietary information may limit what can be presented outside of the organization. Discuss this with your supervisor and course instructor to determine what can be shared with the course instructor.

Assignment requirements:

The final complete project will vary considerably based upon the individual project proposals and the goals of those proposals. To complete this assignment however, the following needs to be included:

- A full copy of the finished project (if proprietary restrictions need to be considered, contact and discuss with your course instructor);
- A 1-2 page executive summary of the project that briefly describes:
 - The purpose of the project;
 - How the outcomes from it will/may be used;
 - The process used to complete the project; and
 - The key ID model/theory that framed your work.
- A 2-4 page (single spaced) written narrative describing:
 - What was learned from completing the project?
 - What were the key challenges and benefits from working on this project?
 - Now with hindsight, what could have been changed to improve the project in a significant manner?
 - Which of your ID skills you feel were improved because of the project and which skills still need more work?
- A brief (3-4 minute) screencast video where you show the project and walk through and point out what it was about, what you think worked well and some of the challenges you worked through.

For specific types of projects, you must also include the following:

- If you develop a **survey** within your project – you must include the instrument and your data.

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- If you develop a **face-to-face workshop** – you must include a facilitator’s guide, agenda for the workshop, and all materials to be used in the workshop or by students.
- If you develop an **e-Learning module** – you must include a checklist of the principles of design (of your own choosing) or discussion of the use of design principles. The module must include interactive elements (voice over PPT or Keynotes is NOT enough for this project).
- If **evaluation** is the main focus of the practicum – you must include data that leads to recommendations for changes. You may find a grid or matrix to be a good way to present this information. All of the original and revised components need to be submitted.

Due date:

Sunday evening at the end of week 7 of the term.

Grading rubric (50 pts.):

- ___ Full, final completed project was submitted in a timely manner. All elements of the project (including the executive summary) were properly included.
- ___ Project is well designed and presented in a professional manner (e.g., proper formatting, no spelling/grammar problems)
- ___ Project goals have been achieved
- ___ Project narrative is well written and addresses each of the key questions outlined in the Assignment requirement section of this document.
- ___ Screencast of the project clearly presents the project and what was accomplished.

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Status Reports/Journal Reflections

Purpose:

The purpose of the progress log is to help you become a reflective practitioner. This reflection will allow you to write about your experience in a way that helps you and others understand the decisions you made and the rationale behind those decisions. It will also allow you to examine the various emotions, politics, and other challenges you will experience as you proceed with your project. Later this assignment will serve as a history that can be used to recall forgotten processes, thoughts, steps and missteps that could be beneficial in future projects. In addition, these reflections give yourself and your course instructor the opportunity to measure your progress against the timeline that you have presented and note any changes and adjustments that need to be completed.

Requirements:

Access the Project Status Report Form in the Course Documents section of this Brightspace course. Fill out that form completely and use the "NOTES" section to describe progress and information about the specific deliverables/components, etc. At the bottom of the form, there is a space for your journal reflection. In that area, you should reflect on these and/or similar questions:

- What progress was made on the project during the previous week(s)?
- What challenges were confronted and in what ways were they addressed?
- What was learned from this week's work on the project?
- Are the goals of the organization being met by my efforts? Are my goals being met by this project?
- What information and/or additional feedback is needed in order to successfully complete the next level of progress?

Due date:

The completed Project Status Report Forms are due on the Sunday evenings of week 3, 5, and week 6 of the course term.

Grading rubric (5pts/week x 3 weeks = 15 pts.):

- ___ The project status was well written, clear, and did not contain grammatical or spelling problems.
- ___ The week's progress, decisions, and/or challenges were explained. The rationales for all key decisions were described.
- ___ Goals and timeline were considered and potential adjustments brought out.

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Online discussion of projects – Week 4

Purpose:

Right in the middle of the term it can be very insightful to bring everyone together and have an open discussion about the challenges faced within the various projects. Each person within the course will present a current challenge/problem that has presented itself within the project. Others within the class will then respond and give insights into potential solution paths that might resolve some if not all of the problem.

Requirements:

This online discussion will occur within the discussion area of Brightspace during the fourth week of the term. Each student will:

- Give a brief description of their practicum project and then identify one key challenge/problem that has occurred within their project; and
- Select a minimum of one other presented project challenge given by a class member and make suggestions on potential ways to overcome that difficulty for that individual.

Due date:

Initial posting of problems should occur by Wednesday of Week 4 and responses to the posted problems should be contributed by Sunday at the conclusion of Week 4.

Grading rubrics (10 pts.):

- ___ Project and key challenge/problem were well described in a concise post within the discussion board.
- ___ Potential possible solution(s) to one or more of the presented class member project challenges was suggested and submitted in a timely fashion within the discussion.

Online discussion of projects – Week 8

Purpose:

At the conclusion of the course, a summary/wrap-up discussion of the individual projects will be made and presented to the rest of the class for their review and comments. The students will select the manner in which this summary will be completed.

Requirements:

This online discussion will occur within the discussion area of Brightspace during the eighth week of the term. Each student will summarize his/her project in one of the following ways:

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- Interview the project supervisor (5 minutes or less) and have him/her describe the project and what it means for the organization. Record the interview and present it in the online discussion;
- Develop a screencast (5 min. or less) of the project and “walk” through and show/describe what was done, favorite/least favorite parts, etc.;
- Describe the current project problem and how it was addressed, then using what you know now, outline a potential redesign of the project solution; or
- Develop a unique way to present your project to highlight the key features and solutions that were developed.

Due date:

Posting of project summarizations should occur by Wednesday of Week 8.

Grading rubrics (10 pts.):

___ Project summarization was presented in an interesting and complete manner within the discussion board.